

Daily Bible Note

Date: June 23, 2026

I. Today's Reading

NKJV: Jonah 3:1-10

1 Now the word of the Lord came to Jonah the second time, saying,

2 "Arise, go to Nineveh, that great city, and preach to it the message that I tell you."

3 So Jonah arose and went to Nineveh, according to the word of the Lord. Now Nineveh was an exceedingly great city, a three-day journey in extent.

4 And Jonah began to enter the city on the first day's walk. Then he cried out and said, "Yet forty days, and Nineveh shall be overthrown!"

5 So the people of Nineveh believed God, proclaimed a fast, and put on sackcloth, from the greatest to the least of them.

6 Then word came to the king of Nineveh; and he arose from his throne and laid aside his robe, covered himself with sackcloth and sat in ashes.

7 And he caused it to be proclaimed and published throughout Nineveh by the decree of the king and his nobles, saying, Let neither man nor beast, herd nor flock, taste anything; do not let them eat, or drink water.

8 But let man and beast be covered with sackcloth, and cry mightily to God; yes, let every one turn from his evil way and from the violence that is in his hands.

9 Who can tell if God will turn and relent, and turn away from His fierce anger, so that we may not perish?

10 Then God saw their works, that they turned from their evil way; and God relented from the disaster that He had said He would bring upon them, and He did not do it.

II. Key Summary

- The word of the Lord comes to Jonah a second time; he obeys, goes to Nineveh, and after one day of walking proclaims that the city will be overthrown in forty days

- The entire city of Nineveh — from the greatest to the least — believes God and responds with fasting and sackcloth; the king steps down from his throne, covers himself with sackcloth and ashes, and issues a decree calling all people to cry out to God and turn from their evil ways
 - God sees that the Ninevites have genuinely turned from their evil ways and relents from the disaster He had planned to bring upon them
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III. Passage Analysis

Topic 1: God Gives a Second Chance to the One Who Failed

"Though Jonah did everything he could to resist the first call of God, after Jonah repented God called him again — though God was under no obligation to do it. He did it out of mercy and grace." [1]

"The second time" in verse 1 carries real weight. God didn't move on to someone more reliable — He came back to the one who ran. For anyone who feels like they've already blown it, this is a direct counterpoint.

Topic 2: Real Repentance Shows Up in What You Do

"God takes notice of every instance of the reformation of sinners and accepts broken, contrite hearts rather than sacrificial offerings." [2]

Verse 10 says "God saw their works, that they turned from their evil way." The Ninevites didn't just feel guilty — they changed their behavior, from the king down to every ordinary citizen. What God responded to was the actual change, not just the emotion behind it.

IV. Reflection Question

Is there something you know needs to change in your life, but you haven't actually done anything about it yet?

God's response in verse 10 wasn't to their sorrow — it was to their "works," to the fact that "they turned from their evil way."

References

[1] Enduring Word, David Guzik, <https://enduringword.com/bible-commentary/jonah-3/>

[2] BibleHub, Benson Commentary,
<https://www.biblehub.com/commentaries/jonah/3-10.htm>